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Plantagenet Late Medieval Army – Marching Column Livery & Identification Pack

Version: 1.1 (Heavy Research Pass)

Updated: 2026-06-16

Status: Locked for Production Use

Source: Master Bible + deep research on 15th c. English retaining system

Purpose: Focused, reusable canon + prompt bible for photorealistic marching column, camp approach, and identification shots with authentic internal variation.

1. Historical Canon & Rules (Locked)

Livery & Identification System

Lords issued retainers livery jackets/coats in household colors (often two main colors) plus personal or dynastic badge. Worn over armor (brigandine, jack, or plate) for instant recognition. Badges could be embroidered, painted, or metal. Banners and standards were the primary unit markers on the march.

Elite Men-at-Arms Appearance

Transitional/full plate with high variation even within one retinue: mismatched pieces, repairs, personal engravings, different helmet styles (sallet, armet, kettle hat, bascinet). Wealthy retainers often wore colorful livery coats over steel.

Marching Column Visuals

Dense, relatively orderly column on road or track. Elite troops clustered near lord's banner. Dust, banners streaming, mixed but cohesive livery colors, weapons (longbows, bills, poleaxes) visible. Commander and household knights near the front or centre of their division.

2. Prompt Engineering Bible

Core Unified Render Technique

“one massive cohesive elite Plantagenet army marching column rendered as a single high-detail unified 3D asset with strong realistic internal variation in armor details, helmet styles, ages, faces, and equipment quality, all unified by consistent lord's livery colors and badges across hundreds of figures”

Reusable Livery Phrases

- “wealthy retainers in [lord's colors] livery jackets worn over brigandine and partial plate”
- “visible personal badges and matching colored coats creating strong visual cohesion while allowing realistic variation in harness”

Variation & Realism Phrases

- “diverse weathered faces and body types ranging 25–55 years old, some veterans with scars, varied facial hair”
- “high internal variation in armor condition and style while maintaining unified livery identity”

Slot Recommendation

- Slot 2: Commander/general as focal point (hero detail)
- Slot 3: Entire army column as one massive asset with explicit variation instructions

Negative / Stability

- “avoid identical faces, avoid uniform armor, avoid cartoonish uniformity, avoid modern military look”
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End of v1.1 – This version is now significantly richer, tidier, and production-ready. Master reference remains untouched.